Rashtra, which is the means and the goal of the Hindu movement in itself.'[32]

The idea that Hindutva is synonymous with the Indian nation and nationalism is not a new one. Vajpayee made exactly the same point in 1992, several months before the demolition of the Babri Masjid in 1992, when he told *Panchjanya* that Hindutva is the basis of Indian nationalism and he saw no difference between the two.[33] Similarly, when L.K. Advani was asked as deputy prime minister in 2003 if a Hindu Rashtra as understood by the RSS would turn India into a theocratic state, he argued, 'Hindu rashtra and theocratic state are contradictory.' Advani pointed to a conversation he had with Guru Golwalkar on the two disputes the Indian state had with the RSS at the time of Independence: on it being a secret organisation and on secularism. The first one was settled easily after the RSS adopted a written constitution. On the second, as he recalled, the 'Government was then involved in the process of drafting the Constitution of India, and the RSS was believed to have been holding contradictory views on both. Shri Guruji cited the example of Great Britain, which has no written Constitution. If a country can be run without a Constitution, why can't an organisation? Even so, RSS had no basic objection drawing up a formal Constitution. Guruji emphasised that Hindi Rashtra has nothing to do with the nature of the state. Just as the Christian-majority European countries have a secular government, we in India have always had a secular state in a Hindu-majority country. So, there is no contradiction between the views of the RSS and the view that there can be no theocratic state here …'[34]

When speaking of a Hindu Rashtra, Sangh leaders often make a subtle distinction between 'rajya' (state) and 'rashtra' (nation). K.S. Sudarshan, joint general secretary of the RSS in 1998, made this point emphatically. 'We must remind ourselves of our "rajyadharma" and "rashtradharma",' he said, 'and understand the subtle difference between rajya and rashtra. The concept of Hindu rashtra should not be confused with a theocratic Hindu rajya which is something absolutely non-existent, like the proverbial flower-in-the-sky.'[35]

The question, of course, is that if India is Hindu, where does it leave the country's religious minorities? And who defines what is